Over cups of tea our conversation went to uninterrupted. Many were the problems we rushed through in our two and a half hours' discussion. M. Rolland was greatly interested in the Congress Socialist Party and its composition. His concern for the continued incarceration of Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru and other politicals was profound. His interest in all actions, speeches and writings of the Mahatma was astonishing. For instance, he pulled out from his old files a statement of the Mahatma in which he had expressed his sympathy for socialism.

We talked at length of Mahatma Gandhi and his tactics. I ventured to remark that the Mahatma would not take a definite stand on economic issues. Whether on political, social or economical question, he was temperamentally a believer in the golden mean. I then referred to what the younger generation regarded as some of the defects in the leadership and tactics—namely, his incorrigible habit of putting all his cards on the table, his opposition to the policy of social boycott of political opponents, his hope of a change of heart on the part of the British Government etc. It did not afford us any satisfaction. I said to oppose him or even criticise him when he had done more for his country than anyone else in recent history and had raised India considerably in the estimation of the whole world. But we loved our country more than any personality.

As our conversation was drawing to a close, I remarked that the views he had expressed that afternoon, would cause surprise in many quarters, since they appeared to be a recent development in his thought-life. This remark worked like an electric button and set in motion a whole train of thought. M. Rolland spoke of the acute mental agony he had passed through since the end of the war in trying to revise his social ideas and his entire ideology. "This combat within myself", he said, "extended over a very wide field and the problem of non-violence, was only a part of it. I have not decided against non-violence, but I have decided that non-violence cannot be the central pivot of our entire social activity. It can be one of its means, one of its proposed forms, still subject to experiment".

Continuing he said : "The primary objective of all our endeavours should be the establishment of another social order, more just and more human. And in order to establish and maintain it, this new order will have to be defended against all the violence of